

IELTS to CLB to CRS: The Conversion Cheat Sheet

Every IELTS General Training band score converted to its Canadian Language Benchmark (CLB) level, and every CLB level converted to CRS points - first language, second language, and spouse contribution.

Accepted English tests for Express Entry: CELPIP-General, IELTS General Training, PTE Core. IELTS One Skill Retake is not accepted. French: TEF Canada, TCF Canada. Results must be less than 2 years old when you apply. CELPIP scores map to CLB levels directly (CELPIP 9 = CLB 9).

Step 1 - Convert IELTS bands to CLB (minimum score per ability)

CLB level	Listening	Reading	Writing	Speaking
CLB 10 +	8.5	8.0	7.5	7.5
CLB 9	8.0	7.0	7.0	7.0
CLB 8	7.5	6.5	6.5	6.5
CLB 7	6.0	6.0	6.0	6.0
CLB 6	5.5	5.0	5.5	5.5
CLB 5	5.0	4.0	5.0	5.0
CLB 4	4.5	3.5	4.0	4.0

How to read the table

Your CLB level for each ability is the highest row whose minimum you meet. Your overall claim is per-ability - one weak ability drags only that ability down, but program minimums (like CLB 7 for FSWP) must be met in **all four**.

Step 2 - Convert CLB to CRS points: first official language

Points are per ability - multiply by what you hold in each of the four.

CLB per ability	With spouse (max 128)	Without spouse (max 136)
CLB 4 or less	0	0
CLB 5	6	6
CLB 6	8	9
CLB 7	16	17
CLB 8	22	23
CLB 9	29	31
CLB 10 or more	32	34

The CLB 8 to CLB 9 jump is worth +8 points per ability (+32 across all four, without spouse) - and it unlocks the top tier of two skill-transferability combinations. It is the highest-ROI retest in the system.

Step 3 - Second official language (e.g. French after English)

CLB per ability	Points per ability (max 24; max 22 with spouse)
CLB 4 or less	0

CLB per ability	Points per ability (max 24; max 22 with spouse)
CLB 5 or 6	1
CLB 7 or 8	3
CLB 9 or more	6

French also carries a separate bonus: NCLC 7+ in all four French abilities adds **50 points** if your English is CLB 5+, or 25 points with CLB 4 or lower English - on top of the second-language points above.

Step 4 - Spouse or partner's language (Section B)

CLB per ability	Points per ability (max 20)
CLB 4 or less	0
CLB 5 or 6	1
CLB 7 or 8	3
CLB 9 or more	5

Worked example

IELTS General Training **L 8.0 / R 7.0 / W 7.0 / S 7.0** converts to CLB 9 in all four abilities. Without a spouse, that is 31 points x 4 = **124 first-language points** - and it satisfies the CLB 9 threshold that maximises both language-based skill-transferability combinations (worth up to 50 points each, capped at 100 for Section C overall).

Sources

Every rule and figure in this document was verified against the following official pages on 19 July 2026:

- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/documents/language-test.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/corporate/publications-manuals/operational-bulletins-manuals/standard-requirements/language-requirements.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/check-score/crs-criteria.html

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